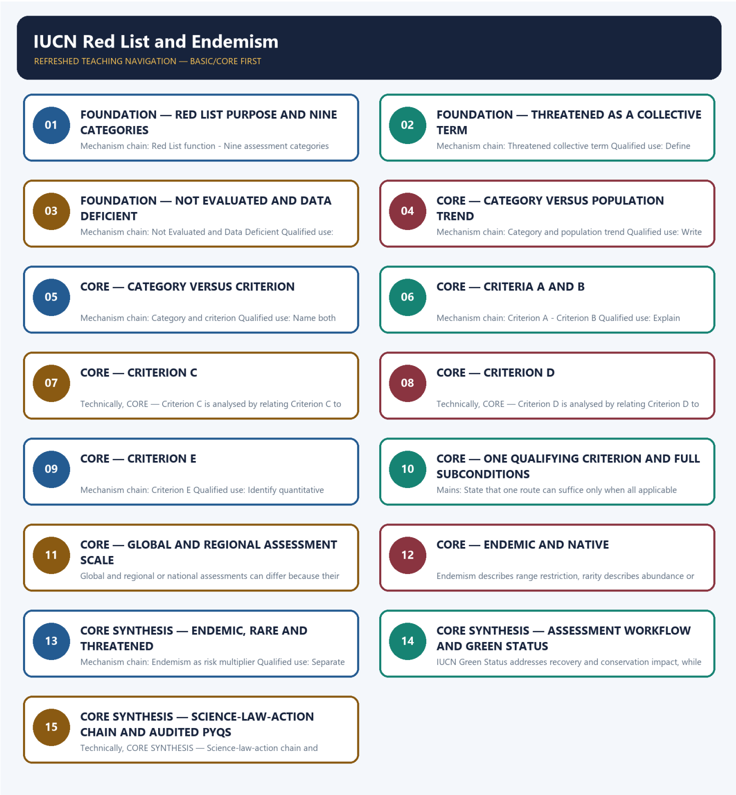
SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

IUCN Red List and Endemism - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

IUCN Red List and Endemism - Solved Practice Workbook

Authoring-only generation: 2026-09-06. Uses the same source-bounded ecological distinctions and strict A-B-C-D rotation.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Red List function?

A. The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. B. The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. C. Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. D. Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe.

Answer: A. Explanation: The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q2. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Red List function?

A. Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. B. The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. C. Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe. D. A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions.

Answer: B. Explanation: The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q3. Which statement uses Red List function without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe. B. A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. C. The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. D. Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E.

Answer: C. Explanation: The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q4. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Red List function?

A. A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. B. Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. C. Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it. D. The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit.

Answer: D. Explanation: The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Nine assessment categories?

A. The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. B. Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. C. Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe. D. A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q6. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Nine assessment categories?

A. Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe. B. The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. C. A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. D. Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q7. Which statement uses Nine assessment categories without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. B. Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. C. The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. D. Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q8. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Nine assessment categories?

A. Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. B. Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it. C. Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text. D. The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Threatened collective term?

A. Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. B. Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe. C. A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. D. Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E.

Answer: A. Explanation: Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q10. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Threatened collective term?

A. A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. B. Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. C. Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. D. Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it.

Answer: B. Explanation: Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q11. Which statement uses Threatened collective term without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. B. Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it. C. Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. D. Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text.

Answer: C. Explanation: Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q12. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Threatened collective term?

A. Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it. B. Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text. C. Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions. D. Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category.

Answer: D. Explanation: Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Not Evaluated and Data Deficient?

A. Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe. B. A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. C. Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. D. Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it.

Answer: A. Explanation: Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q14. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Not Evaluated and Data Deficient?

A. Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. B. Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe. C. Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it. D. Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text.

Answer: B. Explanation: Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q15. Which statement uses Not Evaluated and Data Deficient without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it. B. Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text. C. Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe. D. Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions.

Answer: C. Explanation: Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q16. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Not Evaluated and Data Deficient?

A. Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text. B. Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions. C. Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold. D. Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe.

Answer: D. Explanation: Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Category and population trend?

A. A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. B. Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. C. Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it. D. Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text.

Answer: A. Explanation: A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q18. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Category and population trend?

A. Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it. B. A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. C. Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text. D. Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions.

Answer: B. Explanation: A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q19. Which statement uses Category and population trend without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text. B. Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions. C. A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. D. Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold.

Answer: C. Explanation: A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q20. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Category and population trend?

A. Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions. B. Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold. C. Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount. D. A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions.

Answer: D. Explanation: A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Category and criterion?

A. Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. B. Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it. C. Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text. D. Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions.

Answer: A. Explanation: Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q22. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Category and criterion?

A. Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text. B. Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. C. Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions. D. Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold.

Answer: B. Explanation: Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q23. Which statement uses Category and criterion without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions. B. Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold. C. Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. D. Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount.

Answer: C. Explanation: Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q24. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Category and criterion?

A. Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold. B. Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount. C. The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions. D. Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E.

Answer: D. Explanation: Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Criterion A?

A. Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it. B. Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text. C. Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions. D. Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold.

Answer: A. Explanation: Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it. The other

options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q26. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Criterion A?

A. Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions. B. Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it. C. Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold. D. Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount.

Answer: B. Explanation: Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q27. Which statement uses Criterion A without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold. B. Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount. C. Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it. D. The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions.

Answer: C. Explanation: Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q28. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Criterion A?

A. Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount. B. The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions. C. Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. D. Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it.

Answer: D. Explanation: Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Criterion B?

A. Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text. B. Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions. C. Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold. D. Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount.

Answer: A. Explanation: Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q30. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Criterion B?

A. Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold. B. Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text. C. Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount. D. The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions.

Answer: B. Explanation: Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q31. Which statement uses Criterion B without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount. B. The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions. C. Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text. D. Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year.

Answer: C. Explanation: Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q32. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Criterion B?

A. The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions. B. Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. C. Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic. D. Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text.

Answer: D. Explanation: Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Criterion C?

A. Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions. B. Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold. C. Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount. D. The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions.

Answer: A. Explanation: Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q34. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Criterion C?

A. Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount. B. Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions. C. The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions. D. Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year.

Answer: B. Explanation: Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q35. Which statement uses Criterion C without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions. B. Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. C. Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions. D. Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic.

Answer: C. Explanation: Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q36. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Criterion C?

A. Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. B. Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic. C. Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms. D. Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions.

Answer: D. Explanation: Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Criterion D?

A. Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold. B. Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount. C. The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions. D. Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year.

Answer: A. Explanation: Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q38. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Criterion D?

A. The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions. B. Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold. C. Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. D. Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic.

Answer: B. Explanation: Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q39. Which statement uses Criterion D without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. B. Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic. C. Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold. D. Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms.

Answer: C. Explanation: Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q40. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Criterion D?

A. Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic. B. Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms. C. Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. D. Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold.

Answer: D. Explanation: Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Criterion E?

A. Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount. B. The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions. C. Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. D. Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic.

Answer: A. Explanation: Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q42. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Criterion E?

A. Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. B. Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount. C. Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic. D. Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms.

Answer: B. Explanation: Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q43. Which statement uses Criterion E without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic. B. Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms. C. Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount. D. Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened.

Answer: C. Explanation: Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q44. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Criterion E?

A. Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms. B. Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. C. The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment. D. Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount.

Answer: D. Explanation: Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies One qualifying route?

A. The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions. B. Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. C. Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic. D. Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q46. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of One qualifying route?

A. Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic. B. The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions. C. Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms. D. Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q47. Which statement uses One qualifying route without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms. B. Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. C. The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions. D. The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q48. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about One qualifying route?

A. Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. B. The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment. C. IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other. D. The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Assessment scale?

A. Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. B. Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic. C. Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms. D. Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened.

Answer: A. Explanation: Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q50. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Assessment scale?

A. Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms. B. Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. C. Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. D. The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment.

Answer: B. Explanation: Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q51. Which statement uses Assessment scale without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. B. The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment. C. Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. D. IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other.

Answer: C. Explanation: Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q52. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Assessment scale?

A. The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment. B. IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other. C. The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. D. Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year.

Answer: D. Explanation: Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Endemic and native?

A. Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic. B. Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms. C. Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. D. The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment.

Answer: A. Explanation: Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q54. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Endemic and native?

A. Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. B. Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic. C. The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment. D. IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other.

Answer: B. Explanation: Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q55. Which statement uses Endemic and native without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment. B. IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other. C. Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic. D. The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred.

Answer: C. Explanation: Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q56. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Endemic and native?

A. IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other. B. The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. C. Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. D. Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic.

Answer: D. Explanation: Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Endemic, rare and threatened?

A. Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms. B. Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. C. The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment. D. IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other.

Answer: A. Explanation: Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q58. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Endemic, rare and threatened?

A. The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment. B. Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms. C. IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other. D. The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred.

Answer: B. Explanation: Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q59. Which statement uses Endemic, rare and threatened without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other. B. The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. C. Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms. D. Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred.

Answer: C. Explanation: Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q60. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Endemic, rare and threatened?

A. The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. B. Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. C. The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. D. Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms.

Answer: D. Explanation: Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Endemism as risk multiplier?

A. Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. B. The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment. C. IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other. D. The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred.

Answer: A. Explanation: Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q62. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Endemism as risk multiplier?

A. IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other. B. Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. C. The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. D. Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred.

Answer: B. Explanation: Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q63. Which statement uses Endemism as risk multiplier without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. B. Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. C. Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. D. The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit.

Answer: C. Explanation: Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q64. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Endemism as risk multiplier?

A. Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. B. The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. C. The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. D. Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened.

Answer: D. Explanation: Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Assessment workflow?

A. The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment. B. IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other. C. The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. D. Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q66. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Assessment workflow?

A. The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. B. The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment. C. Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. D. The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q67. Which statement uses Assessment workflow without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. B. The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. C. The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment. D. The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q68. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Assessment workflow?

A. The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. B. The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. C. Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. D. The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Green Status distinction?

A. IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other. B. The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. C. Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. D. The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit.

Answer: A. Explanation: IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q70. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Green Status distinction?

A. Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. B. IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other. C. The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. D. The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct.

Answer: B. Explanation: IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q71. Which statement uses Green Status distinction without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. B. The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. C. IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other. D. Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category.

Answer: C. Explanation: IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q72. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Green Status distinction?

A. The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. B. Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. C. Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe. D. IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other.

Answer: D. Explanation: IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Science-law-action chain?

A. The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. B. Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. C. The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. D. The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q74. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Science-law-action chain?

A. The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. B. The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. C. The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. D. Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q75. Which statement uses Science-law-action chain without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. B. Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. C. The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. D. Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q76. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Science-law-action chain?

A. Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. B. Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe. C. A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. D. The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Audited PYQ boundary?

A. Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. B. The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. C. The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. D. Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category.

Answer: A. Explanation: Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Audited PYQ boundary?", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in "Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Audited PYQ boundary?".

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Audited PYQ boundary? **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** A. Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** B. The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** C. The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** D. Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in "Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Audited PYQ boundary?".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Audited PYQ boundary?", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

Q78. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Audited PYQ boundary?

A. The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. B. Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. C. Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. D. Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe.

Answer: B. Explanation: Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. The other

options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Demand decoding: Treat "Q78. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Audited PYQ boundary?" as a taxon, ecological mechanism, legal category, institution, treaty/status, parameter, unit, chronology and source-date problem.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in "Q78. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Audited PYQ boundary?".

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Q78. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Audited PYQ boundary? **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** A. The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** B. Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** C. Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** D. Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in "Q78. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Audited PYQ boundary?".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: Fix the system/taxon and scale; mark stock/flow and unit; identify the competent law, institution or treaty status; test each statement against mechanism, date, jurisdiction and closest exception.

Why this earns marks: It prevents ecological categories, species statuses, legal schedules, treaty appendices, standards and policy stages from being conflated.

How to improve this answer: For "Q78. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Audited PYQ boundary?", explain why the closest distractor fails on mechanism, scale, taxon, unit, mandate, legal/treaty status, date or causation.

Q79. Which statement uses Audited PYQ boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. B. Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe. C. Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. D. A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions.

Answer: C. Explanation: Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Q79. Which statement uses Audited PYQ boundary without changing its scale, parameter or...", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in "Q79. Which statement uses Audited PYQ boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?".

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Q79. Which statement uses Audited PYQ boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status? **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** A. Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** B. Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** C. Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** D. A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in "Q79. Which statement uses Audited PYQ boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Q79. Which statement uses Audited PYQ boundary without changing its scale, parameter or...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Audited PYQ boundary?

A. Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe. B. A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. C. Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. D. Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred.

Answer: D. Explanation: Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Demand decoding: Treat "Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Audited PYQ boundary?" as a taxon, ecological mechanism, legal category, institution, treaty/status, parameter, unit, chronology and source-date problem.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in "Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Audited PYQ boundary?".

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Audited PYQ boundary? **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** A. Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** B. A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** C. Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit,

source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

5. **Claim and named evidence:** D. Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in "Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Audited PYQ boundary?".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: Fix the system/taxon and scale; mark stock/flow and unit; identify the competent law, institution or treaty status; test each statement against mechanism, date, jurisdiction and closest exception.

Why this earns marks: It prevents ecological categories, species statuses, legal schedules, treaty appendices, standards and policy stages from being conflated.

How to improve this answer: For "Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Audited PYQ boundary?", explain why the closest distractor fails on mechanism, scale, taxon, unit, mandate, legal/treaty status, date or causation.

VERIFIED OBJECTIVE-ONLY PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

Audited ledgers route 2019 Indian endemism and habitat matching, 2022 species identification, 2023 marsupial distribution, 2024 natural-habitat pairs and 2026 Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation. They are carried as answer-free demands; no objective key or unstated current range, trend or assessment year is inferred.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

9. PYQ application

- ANALYSIS: Recurring Prelims pattern: order the Red List categories correctly and identify the

correct definition of "threatened" versus "Data Deficient."

- ANALYSIS: Mains linkage: species-specific case studies (Great Indian Bustard, Gharial, various

Western Ghats amphibians) are used to illustrate the endemism-extinction risk link.

2026 PYQ Integration

> **Status:** 2026 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: `_PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2026.md`. **Answer-key rule:** The 2026 Prelims and CSAT Set-A keys held locally are **provisional**; no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Year represented:** 2026
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2026	Prelims GS-I	22	Western hoolock gibbon conservation status, habitat, and arboreal adaptation	Objective question; provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally, answer not inferred	Provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally (`Ans-■2026-■GS1-■Provisional`); key is provisional - no answer letter recorded or inferred here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Western hoolock gibbon conservation status, habitat, and arboreal adaptation

> This block integrates the 2026 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 blocks and does not convert a provisionally-keyed, answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

> **Status:** 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: `_PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2024-2025.md`. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2024-2025 Prelims Set-A keys are present in the repository and CSAT Set-A keys are supplied; even so, no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Years represented:** 2024
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	Prelims GS-I	23	Country-animal natural habitat pairs (Brazil-Indri, Indonesia-Elk, Madagascar-Bonobo)	Objective question; official Set-A key available locally, answer not inferred	Key available locally (official Set-A answer key present); answer not recorded here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Country-animal natural habitat pairs (Brazil-Indri, Indonesia-Elk, Madagascar-Bonobo)

> This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

> **Status:** Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: `_PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md`. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2019, 2022, 2023
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 4

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2019	Prelims GS-I	22	Wildlife species naturally found only in India	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2019	Prelims GS-I	29	Wildlife species and natural Indian habitats matching	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2022	Prelims GS-I	47	Species identification Golden Mahseer Nightjar Spoonbill Ibis	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2023	Prelims GS-I	12	Marsupials natural habitat and distribution in India	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Wildlife species naturally found only in India
- Wildlife species and natural Indian habitats matching
- Species identification Golden Mahseer Nightjar Spoonbill Ibis
- Marsupials natural habitat and distribution in India

> The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- ANALYSIS: Criterion-based Prelims questions (e.g., "a species with very small population size

even without decline can be classified as...") are best solved by recalling that any one of Criteria A-E suffices for threatened-category qualification.

- ANALYSIS: Mains answers on "species conservation strategy" should explicitly separate the

scientific-assessment layer (IUCN), the domestic legal layer (Wildlife Protection Act) and the judicial-enforcement layer (courts), showing how they interact in a live case like the bustard.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish Red List category, criterion and population trend. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Red List function. **Named evidence/example:** The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Category and population trend. **Named evidence/example:** A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Category and criterion. **Named evidence/example:** Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit.
- A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions.
- Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Red List function. **Named evidence/example:** The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Category and population trend. **Named evidence/example:** A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Category and criterion. **Named evidence/example:** Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Distinguish Red List category, criterion and population trend. Answer in about 150 words.", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Red List function. **Named evidence/example:** The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Category and population trend. **Named evidence/example:** A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Category and criterion. **Named evidence/example:** Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument ->

implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Red List function. **Named evidence/example:** The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Category and population trend. **Named evidence/example:** A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Category and criterion. **Named evidence/example:** Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Distinguish Red List category, criterion and population trend. Answer in about 150 words.", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Explain why Data Deficient is not evidence of low extinction risk. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Nine assessment categories. **Named evidence/example:** The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Threatened collective term. **Named evidence/example:** Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Not Evaluated and Data Deficient. **Named evidence/example:** Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct.
- Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category.
- Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Nine assessment categories. **Named evidence/example:** The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Threatened collective term. **Named evidence/example:** Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Not Evaluated and Data Deficient. **Named evidence/example:** Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on "Explain why Data Deficient is not evidence of low extinction risk. Answer in about 150 words.", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Nine assessment categories. **Named evidence/example:** The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Threatened collective term. **Named evidence/example:** Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Not Evaluated and Data Deficient. **Named evidence/example:** Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Nine assessment categories. **Named evidence/example:** The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Threatened collective term. **Named evidence/example:** Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Not Evaluated and Data Deficient. **Named evidence/example:** Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Explain why Data Deficient is not evidence of low extinction risk. Answer in about 150 words.", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Explain Criteria A-E without inventing taxon-specific thresholds. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Criterion A. **Named evidence/example:** Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Criterion B. **Named evidence/example:** Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Criterion C. **Named evidence/example:** Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Criterion D. **Named evidence/example:** Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Criterion E. **Named evidence/example:** Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** One qualifying route. **Named evidence/example:** The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it.
- Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text.
- Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions.
- Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold.
- Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount.
- The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Criterion A. **Named evidence/example:** Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Criterion B. **Named evidence/example:** Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Criterion C. **Named evidence/example:** Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Criterion D. **Named evidence/example:** Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Criterion E. **Named evidence/example:** Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** One qualifying route. **Named evidence/example:** The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on "Explain Criteria A-E without inventing taxon-specific thresholds. Answer in about 250 words.", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Criterion A. **Named evidence/example:** Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Criterion B. **Named evidence/example:** Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Criterion C. **Named evidence/example:** Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Criterion D. **Named evidence/example:** Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Criterion E. **Named evidence/example:** Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** One qualifying route. **Named evidence/example:** The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text.

Analysis: Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Criterion A. **Named evidence/example:** Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Criterion B. **Named evidence/example:** Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Criterion C. **Named evidence/example:** Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Criterion D. **Named evidence/example:** Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Criterion E. **Named evidence/example:** Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** One qualifying route. **Named evidence/example:** The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Explain Criteria A-E without inventing taxon-specific thresholds. Answer in about 250 words.", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Distinguish endemic, native, rare and threatened species. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Endemic and native. **Named evidence/example:** Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Endemic, rare and threatened. **Named evidence/example:** Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Endemism as risk multiplier. **Named evidence/example:** Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic.
- Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms.
- Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Endemic and native. **Named evidence/example:** Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Endemic, rare and threatened. **Named evidence/example:** Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Endemism as risk multiplier. **Named**

evidence/example: Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Distinguish endemic, native, rare and threatened species. Answer in about 250 words.", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Endemic and native. **Named evidence/example:** Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Endemic, rare and threatened. **Named evidence/example:** Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Endemism as risk multiplier. **Named evidence/example:** Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Endemic and native. **Named evidence/example:** Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Endemic, rare and threatened. **Named evidence/example:** Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Endemism as risk multiplier. **Named evidence/example:** Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Distinguish endemic, native, rare and threatened species. Answer in about 250 words.", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess the value and limits of the IUCN Red List for Indian conservation. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Red List function. **Named evidence/example:** The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Assessment scale. **Named evidence/example:** Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Assessment workflow. **Named evidence/example:** The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Green Status distinction. **Named evidence/example:** IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Science-law-action chain. **Named evidence/example:** The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit.

- Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year.
- The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment.
- IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other.
- The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Red List function. **Named evidence/example:** The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Assessment scale. **Named evidence/example:** Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Assessment workflow. **Named evidence/example:** The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Green Status distinction. **Named evidence/example:** IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Science-law-action chain. **Named evidence/example:** The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on "Assess the value and limits of the IUCN Red List for Indian conservation. Answer in about 300...", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Red List function. **Named evidence/example:** The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Assessment scale. **Named evidence/example:** Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Assessment workflow. **Named evidence/example:** The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Green Status distinction. **Named evidence/example:** IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Science-law-action chain. **Named evidence/example:** The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
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3. **Claim and named evidence:** The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Red List function. **Named evidence/example:** The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Assessment scale. **Named evidence/example:** Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Assessment workflow. **Named evidence/example:** The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Green Status distinction. **Named evidence/example:** IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Science-law-action chain. **Named evidence/example:** The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Assess the value and limits of the IUCN Red List for Indian conservation. Answer in about 300...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Show how scientific assessment should translate into law and habitat action. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Category and criterion. **Named evidence/example:** Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Assessment scale. **Named evidence/example:** Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Endemism as risk multiplier. **Named evidence/example:** Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Science-law-action chain. **Named evidence/example:** The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Audited PYQ boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E.
- Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year.
- Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened.
- The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred.
- Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Category and criterion. **Named evidence/example:** Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Assessment scale. **Named evidence/example:** Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Endemism as risk multiplier. **Named evidence/example:** Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Science-law-action chain. **Named evidence/example:** The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Audited PYQ boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Show how scientific assessment should translate into law and habitat action. Answer in about...", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Category and criterion. **Named evidence/example:** Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Assessment scale. **Named evidence/example:** Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Endemism as risk multiplier. **Named evidence/example:** Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Science-law-action chain. **Named evidence/example:** The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Audited PYQ boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

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1. **Claim and named evidence:** Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
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